

Hail Damage in Pickens, Dawson & Gilmer: What to Inspect Now

When ping-pong-ball-sized hail battered north Georgia on the night of February 26, 2026, a homeowner in Woodstock woke to dented gutters and a scatter of shingle granules pooled at the base of her downspouts - the same storm that left Highway 136 east of Jasper impassable under hail accumulation (Source: [cbs46.com](https://www.cbs46.com), February 2026). Hail that size bruises asphalt shingles even when your roof looks fine from the driveway. Weeks later, those bruises turn into leaks. If you live north or west of the perimeter, your roof deserves a closer look.

The short answer: The February 26, 2026 hail storm dropped stones from pea- to ping-pong-ball-sized across Dawson, Fannin, Gilmer, Lumpkin, and Pickens counties, and homeowners in that corridor and downwind Cherokee and Cobb areas should have their roofs inspected for granule loss, bruising, and dented metal. **Who this affects:** Homeowners in Pickens (Jasper), Dawson, Gilmer, and downwind suburbs like Woodstock, Kennesaw, and Marietta - especially older asphalt-shingle roofs and homes with metal gutters, vents, or flashing. **What to do:** Schedule a professional roof inspection and photo-document all damage before filing an insurance claim. **Timeline:** Within 1-2 weeks of noticing damage, and before the next round of spring weather.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspection to capture close-range, photo-documented reports of hail bruising - evidence that strengthens your insurance claim before an adjuster ever climbs a ladder.

What Hail Damage Signs Should Homeowners in Pickens and Dawson Counties Look For?

Look first for granule loss, circular bruises on shingles, and dents in soft metal like gutters, vents, and flashing. Hail rarely punches a clean hole - instead it bruises the mat beneath the granules, and those bruises fail months later during ordinary rain. The February 26 storm produced stones "ranging in size from peas to ping pong balls," according to Pickens County emergency officials, with enough accumulation to close Highway 136 east of Jasper (Source: [cbs46.com](https://www.cbs46.com), February 2026). Stones that large routinely bruise asphalt shingles and dent aluminum gutters.

From the ground, scan your gutters and downspouts for dents and pooled granules - the earliest visible clue. On the roof itself, damage clusters on the slope that faced the storm. Document everything with dated photos before you touch a shingle.

Which North Georgia Counties Took the Worst of the February 2026 Hail?

Dawson, Fannin, Gilmer, Lumpkin, and Pickens counties were under the severe thunderstorm warning, with hail confirmed in Jasper and Calhoun (Source: [cbs46.com](https://www.cbs46.com), February 2026). Pickens County took a direct hit - its emergency management director called it "likely a very damaging severe weather event," and Highway 136 became impassable from hail accumulation.

Jasper and surrounding Pickens County neighborhoods sit in the hardest-hit corridor, where older ranch homes with 15-to-20-year-old asphalt roofs are most vulnerable to bruising. Downwind, Woodstock and Kennesaw in Cherokee and Cobb counties often catch the trailing edge of these

north Georgia cells, and their 1990s-era subdivisions carry aging three-tab shingles that lose granules fast. Even homeowners in Marietta and Roswell should check, since severe cells frequently track southeast. If a north Georgia storm passed over your ZIP code, treat your roof as potentially affected until inspected.

As a GAF Master Elite certified roofing contractor serving Cherokee, Cobb, Fulton, and Pickens-area homeowners, Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors has documented hail damage across the north Georgia corridor and handles the storm damage restoration that follows.

How Do Aging Shingles and Failed Flashing Turn Hail Into a Denied Claim?

Insurers frequently deny hail claims when they can attribute leaks to age or deferred maintenance rather than the storm - which is why roof condition determines whether your claim succeeds. Hail damage roof repair depends on proving the storm caused the damage, and worn shingles, brittle flashing, or clogged valleys give adjusters a reason to point elsewhere.

Bruised shingles that already lost granules to age look ambiguous under inspection. Cracked or lifted flashing around chimneys and vents leaks whether or not hail hit it. Debris-packed valleys and gutters that dented in the storm can mask the exact impact points an adjuster needs to see. A professional roof inspection with close-range documentation separates fresh hail bruising from ordinary wear - the distinction that keeps a claim alive.

When damage crosses the threshold from repair to roof replacement, Peachtree installs GAF and CertainTeed systems backed by manufacturer warranties, and our team provides insurance claims assistance to document each impact point for your adjuster.

Should You Repair or Replace After Hail in Metro Atlanta?

Whether you repair or replace depends on hail density, shingle age, and how many slopes took impact. Scattered bruising on a newer roof may need targeted work; widespread granule loss on an aging roof usually justifies full roof replacement.

Location & Housing Type	Likely Hail Impact	Recommended Action
Jasper (Pickens) 1990s ranch, aging 3-tab shingles	Widespread bruising, heavy granule loss	Full roof replacement - document all slopes
Woodstock (Cherokee) 2000s subdivision, architectural shingles	Moderate bruising on storm-facing slope	Slope inspection; repair or partial replace

Kennesaw (Cobb) 1990s two-story, dented aluminum gutters	Gutter and flashing dents, some shingle bruising	Gutter and flashing repair; roof inspection
Marietta townhome, shared roof, deferred maintenance	Ambiguous bruising, age-related wear	Full inspection to separate hail from age
Roswell (Fulton) newer build, impact-resistant shingles	Minor cosmetic denting	Document and monitor; likely repair

What Should Homeowners Do in the First Two Weeks After a Hail Storm?

Act in a clear order: document, inspect, then file. First, photograph visible damage from the ground - dented gutters, granule piles, cracked vent covers - with dates. Second, get a professional roof inspection before you call your insurer, so you know what you're claiming. Third, file with complete documentation rather than a vague report.

Never let a contractor or adjuster pressure you into signing before you understand the scope. The February storm damaged vehicles and caused accidents across the region (Source: [cbs46.com](https://www.cbs46.com), February 2026) - a reminder that visible property damage often means roof damage you can't see from the ground. Metro Atlanta's severe weather runs heaviest from April through September, so addressing hail damage now protects you before the next round of storms. Keep every receipt, photo, and inspection report in one folder for your claim.

FAQ

How long do I have to file a hail damage insurance claim in Georgia?

Most Georgia homeowner policies require prompt notice, and many set a window of one to two years from the date of loss - but sooner is always better. The February 26, 2026 hail event gives you a specific, documentable date of loss, which strengthens your claim. Waiting risks new storms muddying whether damage is fresh or old. Get your roof inspected and file within weeks, not months, and confirm your specific deadline in your policy declarations.

What does hail damage actually do to asphalt shingles?

Hail bruises the fiberglass mat beneath the granules, crushing the protective layer and exposing the shingle to UV and water. Stones the size of ping-pong balls - reported across Pickens and Dawson counties in February 2026 - routinely cause this bruising even when the roof looks intact from the ground. The bruise fails weeks or months later, letting water into the deck. That delay is why a professional inspection right after a storm matters more than a driveway glance.

Should I get my roof inspected if I only see dented gutters?

Yes - dented gutters are one of the clearest signals that hail large enough to bruise shingles hit your home. Aluminum gutters and downspouts dent at smaller hail sizes than shingles show visible damage, so they act as an early warning. If your gutters took hits during the February 2026 storm that dented cars across north Georgia, your roof slopes almost certainly did too. Schedule a full roof inspection rather than assuming the roof escaped.

Do I need a roof inspection in Woodstock if the storm was centered in Jasper?

Yes, because north Georgia hail cells frequently track southeast into Cherokee and Cobb counties, carrying damaging stones into Woodstock and Kennesaw. The February 2026 cell moved through multiple counties, and downwind areas often catch the trailing hail core. Older subdivision roofs in these suburbs lose granules quickly under hail. If any hail fell at your address, treat the roof as potentially damaged until a contractor confirms otherwise.

How much does hail damage roof repair or replacement cost in Georgia?

Cost depends on roof size, shingle type, slope count, and whether repair or full replacement is warranted - targeted repairs cost far less than a complete roof replacement. When damage is widespread across an aging roof, insurance often covers replacement minus your deductible. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors offers Wells Fargo financing to help homeowners cover out-of-pocket costs and deductibles. Get a documented inspection first, since the scope of verified damage drives both the cost and what your insurer will pay.

Will filing a hail claim raise my homeowner's insurance rates?

A single weather-related claim tied to a documented regional event, like the February 2026 north Georgia hail storm, is generally treated differently than repeated claims. Because the storm affected multiple counties and was widely reported, your loss is verifiable and clearly not maintenance-related. That documentation helps your claim stand on its own merits. Weigh the repair cost against your deductible, and file when verified damage clearly exceeds it.

What's the difference between cosmetic and functional hail damage?

Functional damage compromises the roof's ability to shed water - bruised mats, fractured shingles, or damaged flashing - while cosmetic damage only affects appearance, like minor denting on impact-resistant shingles. Insurers pay for functional damage but may exclude cosmetic-only marks depending on your policy. The problem is that bruising which looks cosmetic often becomes functional as it degrades. A close-range professional inspection, not a ground-level guess, is the only reliable way to tell them apart.

Can I recover depreciation my insurer withheld on my roof claim?

Often yes - many policies pay actual cash value first, then release the withheld recoverable depreciation once you complete the repair and submit final invoices. This means finishing the work and documenting it can recover the difference between depreciated value and full replacement cost. Keep every invoice and completion record. A contractor experienced in insurance claims documentation can help you assemble the paperwork needed to release that final payment.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

Written by Jonathan Gil, Licensed Roofing Contractor, Metro Atlanta. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors serves homeowners across Metro Atlanta.